

Lab 2: Agile Backlog Creation & Sprint Simulation in Jira

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Problem Statement: Remote Team Time-Tracking & Project Approver

1. Epics & User Stories Summary

Epic 1: Developer Time-Tracking & Activity Logging

Description: Enable remote developers to accurately log work hours, categorize time across specific project tasks, and submit weekly timesheets.

Stories:

Story 1.1: Automated and Manual Task Time Logging

- **Story:** As a Remote Developer, I want to log my work hours either with a start/stop timer or manual entry linked to a project task, so that my daily engineering contributions and billable hours are accurately recorded.
- **Priority:** High
- **Story Points:** 3

Story 1.2: Weekly Timesheet Submission Workflow

- **Story:** As a Remote Developer, I want to submit my consolidated weekly timesheet with task notes for manager review, so that my work is verified and approved for the payroll and project sprint cycle.
- **Priority:** High
- **Story Points:** 2

Story 1.3: Activity Categorization & Task Tagging

- **Story:** As a Remote Developer, I want to tag my logged hours under categories like "Feature Development", "Code Review", or "Bug Fixing", so that the team has granular visibility into sprint time distribution.
- **Priority:** Medium
- **Story Points:** 2

Epic 2: Manager Review, Approvals & Reporting

Description: Provide engineering managers with dashboards to review submitted timesheets, approve or request revisions, and monitor team productivity metrics.

Stories:

Story 2.1: Manager Timesheet Review and Approval Workflow

- **Story:** As an Engineering Manager, I want to review submitted timesheets and approve or reject them with feedback, so that only verified work hours are approved for project billing.
- **Priority:** High
- **Story Points:** 5

Story 2.2: Team Productivity and Utilization Analytics

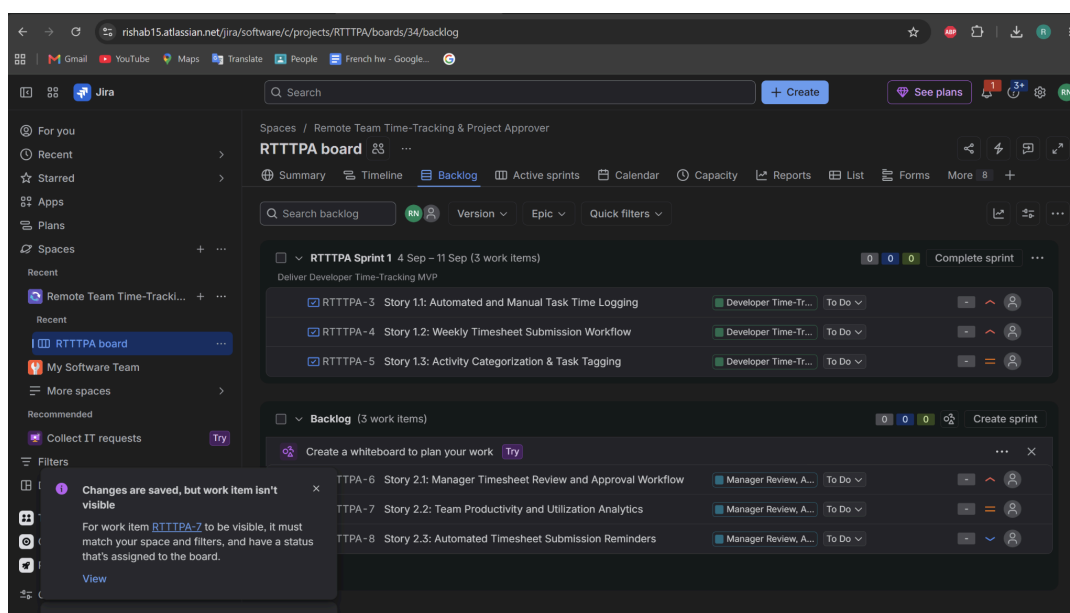
- **Story:** As an Engineering Manager, I want to view a visual dashboard of total logged hours across projects and team members, so that I can identify bottlenecks and manage workload distribution.
- **Priority:** Medium
- **Story Points:** 3

Story 2.3: Automated Timesheet Submission Reminders

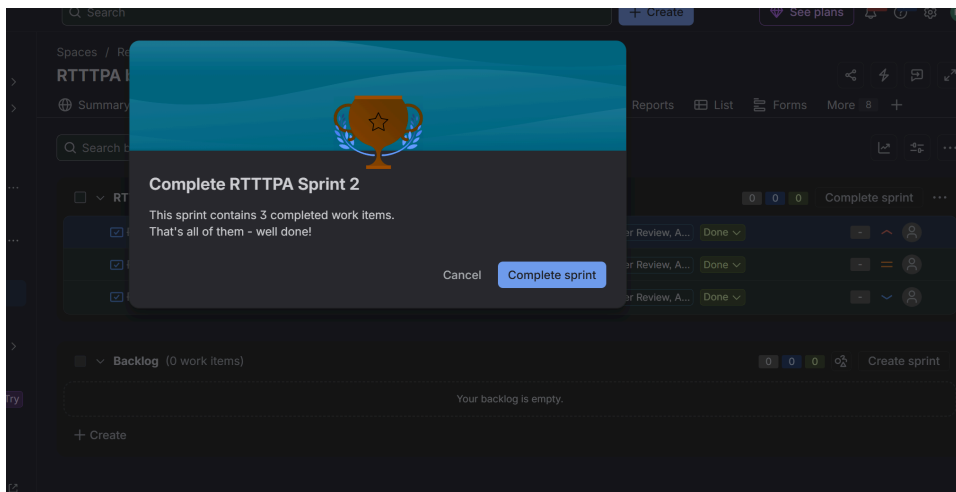
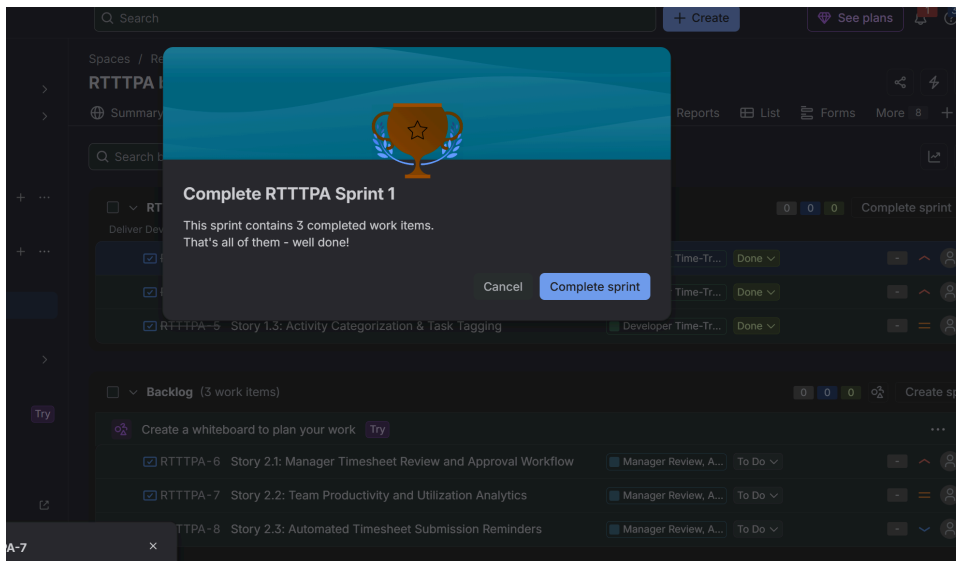
- **Story:** As an Engineering Manager, I want automated notification alerts sent to team members with pending timesheets, so that weekly project approvals are not delayed.
- **Priority:** Low
- **Story Points:** 2

2. Screenshots (Paste your Jira Screenshots here)

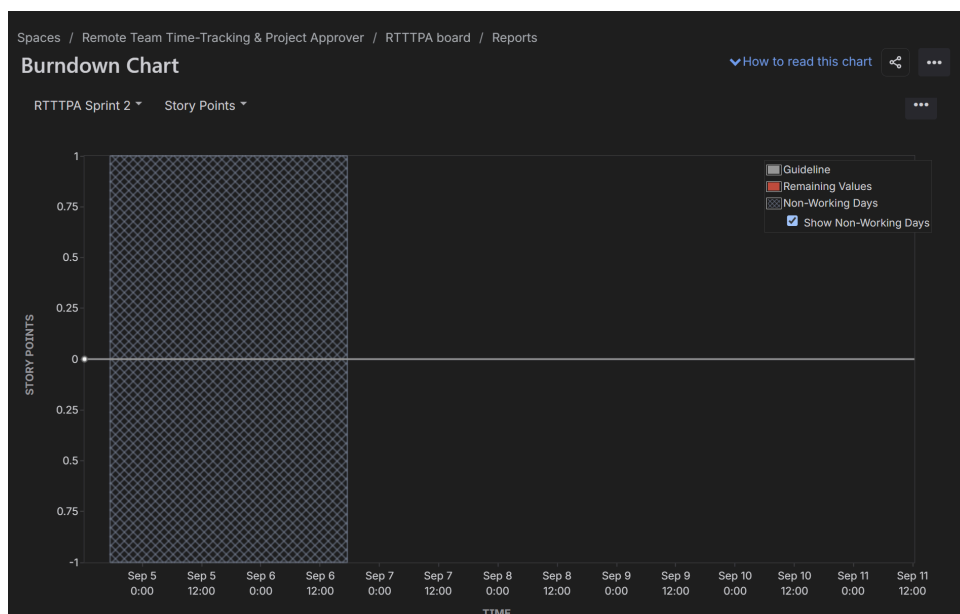
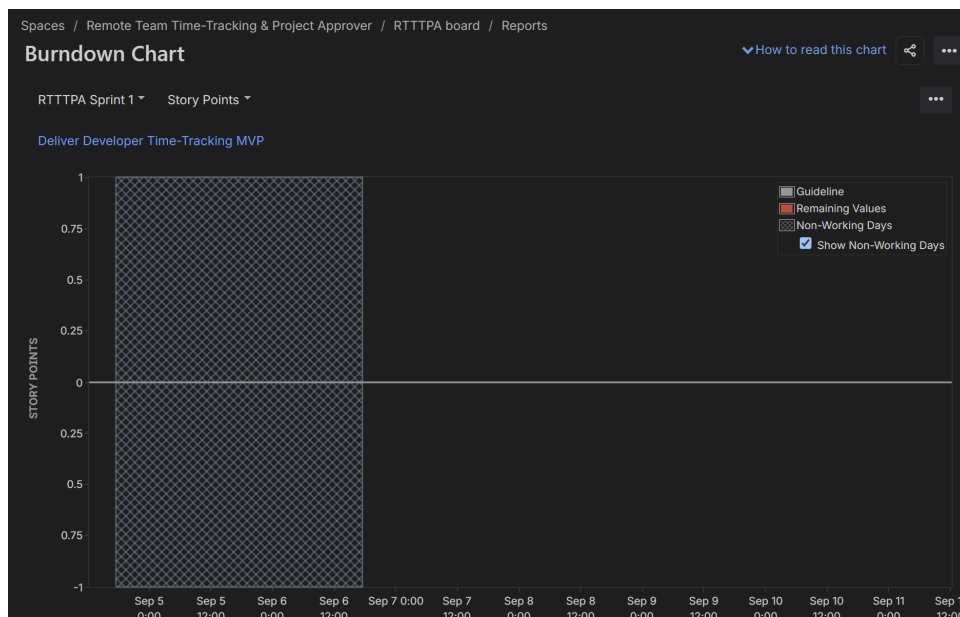
1. Screenshot 1: Backlog View



2. Screenshot 2: Sprint Board (Active Sprint View)



3. Screenshot 3: Burndown Chart



3. Reflection Questions & Answers

Q1: Did your estimations reflect the actual effort?

Answer: Yes. The foundational developer time-logging and submission tasks were estimated at lower story points (2–3 points) using the Fibonacci scale due to standard UI flows. The manager approval workflow was estimated higher at 5 points due to role-based access control, state management, and backend validation requirements.

Q2: Was your backlog well-prioritized?

Answer: Yes. Developer-facing input features (time logging and timesheet submission) were marked as High priority and scheduled in Sprint 1. This ensured time-tracking data was populated before introducing manager approval dashboards and analytics in Sprint 2.

Q3: How did your simulated sprint align with your plan?

Answer: The simulated sprint successfully adhered to the 1-week timebox. All planned story points for the sprint were picked up from the backlog, progressed systematically through the active board (To Do → In Progress → Done), and achieved the sprint goal without scope creep.

Q4: What insights did the burndown chart give about your team's capacity?

Answer: The burndown chart illustrated the team's velocity and completion rate against the ideal linear guideline. In our simulation, the sharp drop reflects quick task closure, highlighting that in actual production sprints, spreading task completion across daily intervals yields a more predictable, steady burndown trajectory.